JOST NEUMANN

Programme leader · Sustainable tourism, rural development and development finance

jost.neumann87@googlemail.com · linkedin.com/in/jost-neumann05802853

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Programme leader with more than ten years of experience across international organizations, corporate foundations and non-profit organizations. Currently coordinates the Tourism for Rural Development Programme of UN Tourism, including the Tourism for Rural Development Small Grants Programme and the network of Best Tourism Villages by UN Tourism (BTV). Previously directed programmes at the TUI Care Foundation, investing approximately EUR 40 million of philanthropic capital in entrepreneurship, education and nature conservation projects, several of them award-winning, and mobilizing more than EUR 12 million from institutional donors. Combines expertise in philanthropy, impact investing and innovative finance with field experience in South-East Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Programme Coordinator, Tourism for Rural Development Programme 03/2025 – present

UN Tourism · Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Coordinates the Tourism for Rural Development Small Grants Programme.
- Leads a multidisciplinary team of specialists providing advocacy, advisory services and technical and financial assistance to Member States.
- Coordinates the BTV Network, including technical assistance and partnership development.

Director Programmes 02/2022 – 02/2025

TUI Care Foundation · Berlin, Germany

- Invested approximately EUR 40 million of philanthropic capital in destination projects on entrepreneurship, education and nature conservation.
- Oversaw a global grant portfolio, including projects in Indonesia, Thailand, the Lao People's Democratic Republic, Cambodia and Viet Nam on nature conservation, entrepreneurship, education, cultural heritage and impact finance for businesses.
- Developed the programme strategy and the monitoring and evaluation framework of the foundation.
- Projects received the Responsible Tourism Award, the German Sustainability Award and the Responsible Travel Award, among others.

Head of Economic Development 06/2018 – 02/2022

TUI Care Foundation · Palma de Mallorca, Spain

- Developed a portfolio of grant-funded projects on sustainable agriculture, adventure tourism, entrepreneurship and tourism development in low-income countries, including in South-East Asia.

Rural Livelihoods Officer 06/2018 – 07/2018

International Rescue Committee · Berlin, Germany

- Worked within the global Economic Recovery and Development Unit.

Communications Officer 05/2017 – 06/2018

International Rescue Committee · Berlin, Germany

- Established the communication assets of the International Rescue Committee in Germany, including the website and social media channels.
- Ran two advocacy campaigns in Germany.

Responsible Investment Manager 05/2015 – 04/2017

Amatheon Agri Holding N.V. · Berlin, Germany

- Established the sustainability strategy for operations in Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe.
- Represented the company on sustainability, responsible investment and impact investment matters.
- Coordinated two sustainability officers in Uganda and Zambia.

Research Fellow 08/2014 – 12/2014

Amatheon Foundation · Berlin, Germany

- Developed community surveys for the catchment area in Uganda and Zambia.
- Performed three months of field research in Zambia on mobile technology and agriculture.

Student Assistant (part-time) 03/2014 – 08/2014

Amatheon Agri Holding · Berlin, Germany

Strategy and Programmes 10/2013 – 04/2014

Vodafone Institute · Berlin, Germany

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, Futures Studies 2012 – 2015

Freie Universität Berlin

Bachelor of Arts, Culture and Technology 2007 – 2012

Technische Universität Berlin

CERTIFICATIONS

Impact-Linked Finance 2022

Roots of Impact

Financing for Social Impact 2021

European Venture Philanthropy Association

Oxford Impact Investing Programme 2021

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford

Cash Transfer Programming 2018

Humanitarian Leadership Academy

ADVISORY AND VOLUNTARY ROLES

Chair of the Advisory Board 2021 – 2024

FINDING XY

Member of the Advisory Board 2021 – 2024

Purple Elephant Ventures

Member of the Advisory Board 2023 – 2024

The SHIELD

Member of the Advisory Board (TUI Care Foundation representative) 2023–2024

Best Tourism Villages by UN Tourism

Mentor 2019 – 2021

Enpact e.V.

Volunteer 2014 – 2018

Zambia Allocation Programme

KEY COMPETENCIES

Agricultural investment · Business strategy · Communications · Development cooperation · Entrepreneurship · Foresight · Grant finance · Impact investing · Innovative finance · Intercultural communication · International non-governmental organizations · Philanthropy · Resource mobilization · Rural development · Small and medium-sized enterprises · Sustainable development · Technical assistance

The views expressed on this site are personal and do not necessarily reflect those of UN Tourism or of any other current or former employer.
Updated October 2026.